

Life in Paris

Paris was to be Chopin's home for the rest of his life. He never saw Poland again, but his music often reflected his heritage and his patriotism. He wrote more than 20 polonaises, a type of composition based on a court dance of the Polish aristocracy, and more than 50 mazurkas, based on a Polish peasant dance. Other groups of his works include nocturnes and waltzes. These are all essentially miniatures, lasting only a few minutes each, but they show inexhaustible melodic invention and have a freedom of construction, a feeling for color and texture, and a wealth of expressive nuance that opened up new paths for piano music.